MHT-CET MBA/MMS — FULL ENGLISH GRAMMAR GUIDE

ELI5 explanations + formal English rules + 5 unique examples for every grammar topic + Error Spotting + Choose the Correct Sentence + 31 exam-relevant Figures of Speech

Why this guide: The uploaded MAH-MBA/MMS-CET 2026 sample uses error identification and sentence correction/rewriting in Verbal Ability, so those skills are explicitly covered here. The official sample also includes passage-based verbal questions.

Important: “All figures of speech” has no universally fixed finite list. This guide therefore covers a broad, exam-relevant set of 31 common figures and gives five examples for each.

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Exam skills: Error Spotting • Choose the Correct Sentence • Mixed revision strategy

Figures of Speech: Simile • Metaphor • Personification • Hyperbole • Alliteration • Assonance • Consonance • Onomatopoeia • Oxymoron • Paradox • Irony • Sarcasm • Euphemism • Litotes • Antithesis • Anaphora • Epistrophe • Climax • Anticlimax • Pun • Allusion • Apostrophe • Metonymy • Synecdoche • Transferred Epithet • Rhetorical Question • Inversion • Pleonasm • Tautology • Pathetic Fallacy • Paronomasia

1. Parts of Speech

ELI5: Words have jobs. A noun names, a pronoun replaces, a verb shows action/state, an adjective describes, an adverb modifies, a preposition shows relation, a conjunction joins and an interjection shows feeling.

English/exam rule: Identify the grammatical job, not just the word itself.

5 unique examples:

- The **manager** approved the plan. (noun)
- **She** approved it. (pronoun)
- The team **celebrated**. (verb)
- It was a **difficult** test. (adjective)
- She answered **quickly**. (adverb)

2. Articles

ELI5: A/an means one but not a specific one; the points to a specific/known thing.

English/exam rule: A/an depends on sound: **a university**, **an hour**, **an MBA**.

5 unique examples:

- She bought **a** laptop.
- He waited for **an** hour.
- Close **the** window beside you.
- She is **a** university student.
- **Books** can change lives. (general)

3. Determiners

ELI5: Determiners tell us which one, how many, how much or whose.

English/exam rule: Common: this/that, these/those, some/any, much/many, few/little, each/every, either/neither, my/your.

5 unique examples:

- **This** question is easier.
- There are **many** candidates.
- We do not have **much** time.
- Only **a few** students left.
- **Each** participant received a badge.

4. Nouns

ELI5: Nouns name people, places, things, ideas, qualities or groups.

English/exam rule: Check singular/plural, countable/uncountable, collective and possessive forms.

5 unique examples:

- The **teacher** explained the rule.
- Mumbai is a busy **city**.
- The **calculator** is here.
- **Honesty** builds trust.
- The **team** celebrated its win.

5. Pronouns

ELI5: Pronouns avoid repeating nouns.

English/exam rule: Check subject/object, possessive, reflexive and relative pronouns.

5 unique examples:

- **She** completed the assignment.
- The coach praised **him**.
- This seat is **mine**.
- He prepared it **himself**.
- The student **who** won smiled.

6. Adjectives

ELI5: Adjectives describe nouns/pronouns. Ask: what kind, which one, how many?

English/exam rule: Watch adjective order and comparison; avoid double comparatives.

5 unique examples:

- A **clear** explanation.
- A **large** hall.
- **Five** questions.
- An **interesting** lecture.
- The **broken** chair.

7. Comparison of Adjectives

ELI5: Positive describes; comparative compares two; superlative compares three or more.

English/exam rule: Use taller/tallest or more useful/most useful. Avoid more better/most best.

5 unique examples:

- This book is **useful**.
- This is **more useful** than that one.
- This is the **most useful** book.
- Today is **better** than yesterday.
- That was the **worst** mistake.

8. Adverbs

ELI5: Adverbs commonly tell how, when, where or how often.

English/exam rule: Many end in -ly, but fast, hard, late and well can also be adverbs.

5 unique examples:

- She spoke **clearly**.
- We leave **tomorrow**.
- Wait **outside**.
- He **often** practises.
- It was **very** difficult.

9. Verbs

ELI5: Verbs show action, state or occurrence.

English/exam rule: Check main/helping/modal verbs, tense and form.

5 unique examples:

- They **solved** the puzzle.

- She **knows** the answer.
- He **is** studying.
- You **should** revise.
- She **opened** the door.

10. Tenses

ELI5: Tense tells when an action/state happens.

English/exam rule: Learn simple, continuous, perfect and perfect continuous; use time markers as clues.

5 unique examples:

- She **studies** every evening.
- She **is studying** now.
- She **studied** yesterday.
- She **had finished** before dinner.
- She **will study** tomorrow.

11. Subject–Verb Agreement

ELI5: The verb must match the real subject in number.

English/exam rule: Each/every/neither/either normally take singular verbs; ignore distracting phrases between subject and verb.

5 unique examples:

- The student **is** ready.
- The students **are** ready.
- Each player **has** a jersey.
- Neither answer **is** correct.
- The box of books **is** heavy.

12. Prepositions

ELI5: Prepositions show place, time, direction or relationship.

English/exam rule: Memorise fixed combinations such as good at, interested in, responsible for, depend on, capable of.

5 unique examples:

- Keys are **on** the table.
- Class starts **at** 9.
- She walked **towards** the gate.
- He is interested **in** finance.
- Success depends **on** practice.

13. Conjunctions

ELI5: Conjunctions join words, phrases or clauses.

English/exam rule: Know coordinating, subordinating and correlative conjunctions.

5 unique examples:

- Riya **and** Aman prepared.
- He was tired, **but** continued.
- She stayed home **because** it rained.
- **Either** study now **or** revise later.

- **Although** it was late, they continued.

14. Phrases & Clauses

ELI5: A phrase is not a complete clause; a clause has a subject and verb.

English/exam rule: Recognise independent, dependent, relative and adverb clauses.

5 unique examples:

- The girl **in the blue dress** smiled.
- **She smiled.**
- **Because she was happy**, she smiled.
- The book **that you gave me** is useful.
- We left **when the rain stopped**.

15. Modals

ELI5: Modals show ability, possibility, permission, advice or necessity.

English/exam rule: Modal + base verb: can go, should study, must finish.

5 unique examples:

- She **can** solve it.
- You **should** revise.
- You **may** leave.
- Candidates **must** carry ID.
- It **might** rain.

16. Conditionals

ELI5: Conditionals link a condition with a result.

English/exam rule: Zero: present/present; first: present/will; second: past/would; third: had + V3/would have + V3.

5 unique examples:

- If you heat ice, it **melts**.
- If she studies, she **will improve**.
- If I had time, I **would practise**.
- If he had prepared, he **would have succeeded**.
- If she had slept earlier, she **would feel** better now.

17. Active & Passive Voice

ELI5: Active focuses on the doer; passive focuses on the receiver.

English/exam rule: Passive normally uses be + past participle and preserves the tense.

5 unique examples:

- They **solve** the problem → It **is solved**.
- She **wrote** the letter → It **was written**.
- They **will announce** the result → It **will be announced**.
- You **must complete** it → It **must be completed**.
- Who wrote the report? → **By whom was it written?**

18. Direct & Indirect Speech

ELI5: Direct speech quotes exact words; indirect speech reports them.

English/exam rule: Watch pronouns, tense backshift, time words and question structure.

5 unique examples:

- “I am ready.” → She said she **was ready**.
- “I finished.” → He said he **had finished**.
- “Are you ready?” → He asked **whether I was ready**.
- “Where do you live?” → She asked **where I lived**.
- “Open the door.” → He **ordered me to open** it.

19. Gerunds

ELI5: A gerund is an -ing form functioning as a noun.

English/exam rule: Common after enjoy, avoid, finish, suggest, mind and practise.

5 unique examples:

- **Reading** improves vocabulary.
- She enjoys **reading**.
- He is interested in **learning**.
- They avoided **arguing**.
- I appreciate your **helping** me.

20. Infinitives

ELI5: An infinitive is usually to + base verb; it can express purpose or follow certain verbs.

English/exam rule: Know want to, decide to, hope to, plan to and bare infinitive after let/make.

5 unique examples:

- She studied **to improve**.
- He decided **to practise**.
- **To learn** takes patience.
- I have a book **to read**.
- Let him **go**.

21. Participles

ELI5: Participles are verb forms used in verb phrases or as adjectives.

English/exam rule: Watch -ing vs past participle and avoid dangling modifiers.

5 unique examples:

- The **shining** stars looked beautiful.
- The **broken** window was repaired.
- **Having finished**, she left.
- They are **preparing**.
- The answer was **written** carefully.

22. Question Tags

ELI5: A short question is added to a statement; positive normally takes negative and vice versa.

English/exam rule: Use the same auxiliary/modal and matching pronoun.

5 unique examples:

- She is ready, **isn’t she?**

- He isn’t late, **is he?**
- You can swim, **can’t you?**
- They finished, **didn’t they?**
- Open the window, **will you?**

23. Parallelism

ELI5: Items joined together should have the same grammatical shape.

English/exam rule: Keep forms parallel after and, or, either-or, not only-but also.

5 unique examples:

- She likes **reading, writing and travelling**.
- He wants **to learn, to practise and to improve**.
- Wrong: reading, writing and **to travel**; right: **travelling**.
- The course is **interesting as well as practical**.
- It is **not only difficult but also time-consuming**.

24. Common Confusing Words

ELI5: Similar-looking/sounding words can have different meanings.

English/exam rule: Learn them as pairs and use context.

5 unique examples:

- **It’s** raining; the company changed **its** policy.
- **They’re** waiting **there** with **their** books.
- **You’re** responsible for **your** work.
- Sleep can **affect** focus; the **effect** was obvious.
- The **principal** explained the school’s **principle**.

25. ERROR SPOTTING — HOW TO SOLVE

ELI5: A sentence is split into parts. One part may contain a grammar mistake. Find it; if all parts are correct, choose No Error.

Order of checking: Subject → Verb → Pronoun → Article/Determiner → Preposition → Adjective/Adverb → Tense → Parallelism.

1. Each of the players / have received / a certificate / after the event.

Answer: Part 2: **have** → **has**. Each is singular.

2. She / is one of the best student / in the class / this year.

Answer: Part 2: **student** → **students**. One of the + plural noun.

3. Neither of the answers / are / correct / according to the key.

Answer: Part 2: **are** → **is** in standard exam grammar.

4. He is good / in mathematics / but weak / in English.

Answer: Part 2: **in** → **at**; we say good at.

5. She completed the work / quick / and submitted it / before lunch.

Answer: Part 2: **quick** → **quickly**; the word modifies the verb.

6. The teacher asked / Rahul and I / to wait / outside.

Answer: Part 2: **I** → **me**; object of asked.

7. He has completed / the assignment / yesterday / without help.

Answer: Part 3 creates a tense mismatch; use simple past: He completed the assignment yesterday.

8. The list of topics / are / on the desk / near the window.

Answer: Part 2: **are** → **is**; subject is list.

The uploaded MAH-MBA/MMS-CET 2026 sample explicitly uses the broken-into-parts error-identification format and includes No Error as an option.

26. CHOOSE THE CORRECT SENTENCE

ELI5: The options are almost identical. Compare them word-by-word. Check agreement, tense, article, pronoun, preposition and word order.

1. A) She is a honest student.
B) She is an honest student.
C) She is honest a student.
D) She is an honesty student.

Answer: B — honest begins with a vowel sound.

2. A) Neither of the boys are ready.
B) Neither of the boys is ready.
C) Neither boys is ready.
D) Neither of boys are ready.

Answer: B — neither is singular here.

3. A) He has went home.
B) He has gone home.
C) He had go home.
D) He has going home.

Answer: B — has + past participle.

4. A) I prefer tea than coffee.
B) I prefer tea to coffee.
C) I prefer tea from coffee.
D) I prefer tea over than coffee.

Answer: B — standard pattern: prefer X to Y.

5. A) The news are surprising.
B) The news is surprising.
C) The news were surprising.
D) The news have surprising.

Answer: B — news is treated as singular.

6. A) She is capable to solve it.
B) She is capable of solving it.
C) She is capable for solve it.
D) She is capable solving it.

Answer: B — capable of + gerund.

7. A) One of my friend is preparing.
B) One of my friends is preparing.
C) One of my friends are preparing.
D) One of my friend are preparing.

Answer: B — one of + plural noun + singular verb.

8. A) She suggested me to study.
B) She suggested that I study.
C) She suggested me studying.
D) She suggested to me study.

Answer: B — standard formal construction.

27. FIGURES OF SPEECH — EXAM-RELEVANT SET

There is no single universally agreed finite list of every figure of speech. The set below covers the major/common forms useful for entrance-exam identification. Each has five examples.

Simile

Meaning: Comparison using like/as

1. Her smile was **like sunshine**.
2. He slept **like a log**.
3. She ran **as fast as the wind**.
4. The room was **like an oven**.
5. Her voice was **as soft as silk**.

Metaphor

Meaning: Direct comparison without like/as

1. Time is **a thief**.
2. Her voice **was music**.
3. The city **is a jungle**.
4. His words **were arrows**.
5. Knowledge **is power**.

Personification

Meaning: Giving human qualities to non-human things

1. The wind **whispered**.
2. The alarm clock **screamed**.
3. The moon **watched** us.
4. Opportunity **knocked**.
5. The old house **groaned**.

Hyperbole

Meaning: Deliberate exaggeration

1. I told you **a million times**.
2. This bag weighs **a ton**.
3. She waited **forever**.
4. He was **dying of embarrassment**.
5. That was **the hardest exam on Earth**.

Alliteration

Meaning: Repeated initial consonant sound

1. **Wild winds whistle**.
2. **Peter picked purple plums**.
3. **Busy bees buzzed**.
4. **Silver snakes slid**.
5. **Bright blue balloons** floated.

Assonance

Meaning: Repeated vowel sound

1. The **light** of the **fire** shone bright.

2. The **mellow wedding bells** rang.
3. The **cool moon** moved slowly.
4. He **tried to hide** the sign.
5. The **rainy day** faded away.

Consonance

Meaning: Repeated consonant sound within/end of words

1. The **stroke of luck** helped.
2. The **blank and think** pattern repeats a consonant sound.
3. The **lumpy, bumpy** road shook.
4. The wind **bent the tent**.
5. The **crisp clasp** snapped.

Onomatopoeia

Meaning: A word imitates a sound

1. The door went **bang**.
2. The bees **buzzed**.
3. The clock went **tick-tock**.
4. Water **sizzled**.
5. The snake **hissed**.

Oxymoron

Meaning: Contradictory words together

1. **deafening silence**
2. **bittersweet** memory
3. **jumbo shrimp**
4. **living dead**
5. **seriously funny**

Paradox

Meaning: Apparently contradictory statement with a deeper idea

1. **Less is more.**
2. **The more you learn, the less you know.**
3. **The only constant is change.**
4. **To save money, you sometimes spend money.**
5. **Freedom requires rules.**

Irony

Meaning: Contrast between expectation/reality or literal/intended meaning

1. A fire station burns down.
2. A traffic officer gets a speeding ticket.
3. A dentist has terrible teeth.
4. A weather expert forgets an umbrella in rain.
5. After disaster: **What a perfect result.**

Sarcasm

Meaning: Mocking or cutting irony

1. After a huge mistake: **Brilliant job!**
2. To someone late: **Nice of you to join us.**
3. During rain: **Perfect beach weather.**
4. After breaking a printer: **Exactly what we needed.**
5. Seeing a messy desk: **Beautiful organisation.**

Euphemism

Meaning: Softer expression for an unpleasant idea

1. **passed away** = died
2. **let go** = fired
3. **between jobs** = unemployed
4. **economical with the truth** = lying
5. **senior citizen** = elderly person

Litotes

Meaning: Understatement through negation

1. It is **not bad**.
2. She is **not unfamiliar** with it.
3. That was **no small achievement**.
4. He is **not unintelligent**.
5. The result is **not insignificant**.

Antithesis

Meaning: Balanced contrast of opposing ideas

1. **Speech is silver; silence is golden.**
2. **Many are called, few are chosen.**
3. **Easy to begin, hard to finish.**
4. **Hope for the best, prepare for the worst.**
5. **Small step, giant leap.**

Anaphora

Meaning: Repetition at the beginning

1. **We will** learn. **We will** practise.
2. **Every day** she reads; **every day** she writes.
3. **This is** our time; **this is** our chance.
4. **I want** focus; **I want** discipline.
5. **Never** give up; **never** stop learning.

Epistrophe

Meaning: Repetition at the end

1. We work for **success**, study for **success**.
2. They asked for **justice**, fought for **justice**.
3. She wanted to **learn**, lived to **learn**.
4. We prepare for **today**, work for **today**.
5. He spoke with **courage**, acted with **courage**.

Climax

Meaning: Ideas rise in intensity

1. He whispered, spoke, shouted.
2. She learned, practised, mastered.
3. He risked time, money, reputation.
4. The problem became difficult, serious, disastrous.
5. A spark became a flame, then a wildfire.

Anticlimax

Meaning: Build-up suddenly drops to something trivial

1. He trained for months and forgot his shoes.
2. She expected a grand surprise and received a pen.
3. The speech promised revolution and ended with a coupon.
4. He solved the crisis and lost his lunch.
5. They planned an epic trip and stayed in the lobby.

Pun

Meaning: Wordplay using double meaning/similar sounds

1. A bicycle cannot stand because it is **two-tired**.
2. The calendar's days are **numbered**.
3. A boiled egg is **hard to beat**.
4. The banker **lost interest**.
5. The math teacher has too many **problems**.

Allusion

Meaning: Indirect reference to a known person/place/story/event

1. He met his **Waterloo**.
2. She is a **Romeo**.
3. It became our **Trojan horse**.
4. He has the patience of **Job**.
5. She opened a **Pandora's box**.

Apostrophe

Meaning: Direct address to an absent person/object/idea

1. **O Time**, slow down!
2. **Dear Moon**, light my path.
3. **O Justice**, where are you?
4. **Death**, do not take him yet.
5. **Freedom**, we value you.

Metonymy

Meaning: A related thing stands for the thing meant

1. The **crown** announced a decision.
2. The **White House** issued a statement.
3. The **press** asked questions.
4. The **bench** delivered its ruling.
5. The **stage** applauded her work.

Synecdoche

Meaning: Part represents whole or whole represents part

1. All **hands** on deck.
2. More **boots** on the ground.
3. Nice **wheels**.
4. Many new **faces** arrived.
5. We need more **hands** for the project.

Transferred Epithet

Meaning: Adjective is attached to one noun but logically describes another

1. A **sleepless night**.
2. The **angry streets** were crowded.
3. A **restless journey**.
4. A **miserable holiday**.
5. A **thoughtful look**.

Rhetorical Question

Meaning: Question asked for effect, not a real answer

1. **Who doesn't want success?**
2. **How could I forget you?**
3. **Isn't this amazing?**
4. **What is more important than time?**
5. **Do we really need another excuse?**

Inversion

Meaning: Unusual/reversed word order for emphasis

1. **Never have I seen** such a view.
2. **Rarely does she complain.**
3. **Down came the rain.**
4. **Only then did he understand.**
5. **So difficult was the test** that many struggled.

Pleonasm

Meaning: More words than necessary; meaning repeats

1. **free gift**
2. **final conclusion**
3. **past history**
4. **advance planning**
5. **new innovation**

Tautology

Meaning: Same idea repeated in different words

1. **each and every**
2. **null and void**
3. **first and foremost**
4. **safe and sound**

5. **true fact**

Pathetic Fallacy

Meaning: Nature is given human emotion/quality, often reflecting mood

1. The **angry storm** raged.
2. The **cheerful sun** welcomed morning.
3. The **gloomy clouds** followed his sadness.
4. The **jealous sea** swallowed the boat.
5. The **lonely wind** cried at night.

Paronomasia

Meaning: Sound-based wordplay, closely related to pun

1. The musician got into **treble**.
2. The gardener's work is **growing** on him.
3. The electrician had a **shocking** career.
4. The fisherman was **hooked** on the idea.
5. The sole survivor had a **sole** story.

FINAL REVISION CHECKLIST

✓ Articles: a/an depends on sound; the = specific/known; zero article is common for general plurals/uncountables.

✓ Pronouns: check subject/object forms and agreement.

✓ Agreement: ignore words between the subject and verb.

✓ Tenses: use time markers as clues and keep the timeline logical.

✓ Prepositions: learn common combinations such as good at, interested in, capable of.

✓ Adjective vs adverb: adjective describes a noun; adverb commonly describes a verb/adjective/adverb.

✓ Gerund vs infinitive: learn verb patterns.

✓ Parallelism: joined elements should have matching grammatical forms.

✓ Error spotting: check one rule at a time.

✓ Correct sentence: compare every option word-by-word.

✓ Figures of speech: identify the clue first—comparison, exaggeration, human quality, sound, contradiction, repetition, wordplay, association or part-whole.

Suggested study sequence

Articles/Nouns/Pronouns/Adjectives → Adverbs/Verbs → Tenses → Agreement → Prepositions/Conjunctions → Clauses → Modals/Conditionals → Voice/Narration → Gerunds/Infinitives/Participles → Error Spotting → Choose Correct Sentence → Figures of Speech → mixed timed practice.